03 | EISENHOWER CHART | RESOURCE

Eisenhower Chart: Setting Priorities

Sort work by your real duties and the authority you have

Urgent means time-sensitive: something happens if it waits. Important means it matters to required work, services, safety, or agreed goals. Some requests feel urgent but aren't the best use of your time.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Real deadline or service risk. Handle it now through the proper channel.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Planning, prevention, training, and required work. Book time for it before it turns urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Someone else's urgency. Confirm it, then pass it on, delegate it, or reset the timeline if you're allowed to.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Not required and not useful. Once you've confirmed that, scale it back or drop it.

Start with your role

Your job duties, your branch RACI, current procedures, and your supervisor's expectations tell you what's important. A request from someone senior still has to be checked against the real service need and deadline.

Office Hours and focus time

Save non-urgent questions for Office Hours or the published support schedule when you can. Use focus time to finish important work, work through requests, and answer messages. Urgent service or safety issues go through the required process right away. Don't hold them for Office Hours.

> **Watch out for these**
> Q3 doesn't mean pushing every urgent request onto someone else. Q4 doesn't mean skipping required work. Before you change or stop anything, make sure it isn't needed and that you're allowed to.

Based on: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.

Learn more: FranklinCovey: urgency and importance

03 | EISENHOWER CHART | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Eisenhower Chart: Examples and Planning

Examples only. Your facts and role could put a task in a different box.

Example	Quadrant	What to do
There's no coverage for the next required service window.	Q1	Use the proper process to cover the service risk now.
A better job aid would stop the same questions from coming in.	Q2	Book time to write it and get any review it needs.
Someone wants an optional font change by noon. It doesn't affect the work.	Q3	Check the deadline and the reason. Reset the timeline or reroute it if you're allowed to.
Someone is still polishing an optional flyer for a canceled event.	Q4	Make sure nothing still needs it, then stop or scale it back.

Plan one important task

Use this space	Your notes
Task and why it matters	
Deadline and time blocked	
Quadrant, next step, owner	
What finished looks like	

Look back

Did you use the time you blocked? What got in the way? Did the work cut repeat questions, reduce rework, or help service? Adjust and try again.

> **Commit to a next step**
> "I'll finish _____ during _____. The result will be _____. I need _____ to confirm _____."

Based on: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.